

Modbus RTU Driver V7 — Library for Coolmay FX3G PLC

Abstract

The Modbus RTU Driver enables a Coolmay FX3G PLC to operate as a Modbus RTU master or slave on its two auxiliary RS485 ports (port 2 and port 3). Communication channels are configured through an application-declared array `MB_CHANNELS` of type `MB_REG_50`; a single function block, `MB_PROCESS_50`, cycles through that array and issues the underlying `ADPRW` read/write requests on a **50 ms** tick.

Version V7 changes the channel-storage model: the `MB_CHANNELS` array and the `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM` capacity constant are no longer declared by the library. The application declares them in its own global label list, sized to the number of channels it actually uses, and `MB_PROCESS_50` cycles through exactly that many channels. This keeps the automatically-assigned device usage proportional to the number of channels actually configured.

Prerequisites

1. The following libraries must be installed in the project before this driver:

- `Utils.sul`
- `TimeControl.sul`

2. The TimeControl library's `TCO_TICKER_50` ticker must be running. It advances at **50 ms** intervals and drives the internal scheduling of `MB_PROCESS_50`.

3. The application must declare the Modbus channel storage in its own global label list before using `MB_PROCESS_50`:

- `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM` — `VAR_GLOBAL_CONSTANT` (`INT`), the upper bound (last valid index) of the channel array.
- `MB_CHANNELS` — `VAR_GLOBAL` (`ARRAY [0..c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM] OF MB_REG_50`), the channel array itself.

The literal array bound must match `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM`. For three channels (indices 0–2), declare `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM := 2` and `MB_CHANNELS : ARRAY [0..2] OF MB_REG_50`.

4. This library is compatible with **GX Works 2 v1.631H** and later. Updates are available from the `coolmay/soft` directory.

Terminology

- **Channel** — A single configured Modbus read/write relationship, described by one element of `MB_CHANNELS`.

- **Register channel** — A channel that transfers 16-bit register data (function codes `H3`, `H4`, `H6`, `H10`). Its value buffer lives in the `D` device area.
- **Coil channel** — A channel that transfers discrete bit data (function codes `H1`, `H2`, `H5`, `HF`). Its value buffer lives in the `M` device area.
- **Scratch buffer** — A `D`-area workspace used by `MB_PROCESS_50` during `ADPRW` transfers, starting at the `mb_iBuffer` base device.

Type names: this document uses the IEC type names written in the GX Works 2 label CSV files. The Label Editor displays them as follows:

IEC type	GX Works 2 Label Editor display
<code>BOOL</code>	Bit
<code>INT</code>	Word [Signed]
<code>WORD</code>	Word [Unsigned] / Bit String [16-bit]
<code>DWORD</code>	Double Word [Unsigned]

Architectural Description

This library enables a Coolmay FX3G PLC to operate as a **Modbus Slave** or a **Modbus Master** (on the secondary and tertiary RS485 ports — ports 2 and 3, respectively) for reading from and writing to Modbus RTU devices. It provides a low-overhead interface for configuring and managing Modbus communication channels.

The Modbus channels are described in a user-declared global array `MB_CHANNELS` of type `MB_REG_50`. The library does not fix the channel count: the application declares the array and the `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM` upper bound in its global label list, and `MB_PROCESS_50` cycles through exactly that many channels.

Coolmay PLC/HMI integrated units are equipped with two RS485 ports: port 2 is exposed on the terminal connector, and port 3 is exposed on the DB9 connector. L02-series PLCs also provide two RS485 ports, both on terminal connectors.

The recommended workflow is:

1. At startup (under the `M8002` initialisation pulse), configure the timeout globals and the `MB_CHANNELS` array.
2. Initialise the required ports with `MB_PORT_SETTINGS` and the relevant `MB_*_INIT_*` function. Re-trigger the initialisation periodically after startup (see the timing note in § Modbus Master).
3. Call `fbMbProcess` every scan (or at least faster than the shortest `tCycle`).

Calling convention: the port-initialisation and settings POU's are *functions* that return their result through the function name. In GX Works 2 a function call used as a statement requires a left-hand side, so callers assign the result to a dummy bit, e.g. `M0 := MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT2(TRUE, PortSettings);`. The result value is not used elsewhere.

Function Blocks and Functions

Name	Type	Description
<code>MB_PORT_SETTINGS</code>	Function	Build the serial-port bit-field (parity, stop bits, baud rate).
<code>MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT2</code>	Function	Initialise the Modbus master on port 2.
<code>MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT3</code>	Function	Initialise the Modbus master on port 3.
<code>MB_SLAVE_INIT_PORT2</code>	Function	Initialise the Modbus slave on port 2.
<code>MB_SLAVE_INIT_PORT3</code>	Function	Initialise the Modbus slave on port 3.
<code>MTB_SLAVE_PORT2</code>	Function	Reconfigure port 2 for the Mitsubishi protocol.
<code>MTB_SLAVE_PORT3</code>	Function	Reconfigure port 3 for the Mitsubishi protocol.
<code>MB_PROCESS_50</code>	Function Block	Cycle through channels and issue <code>ADPRW</code> read/write requests.
<code>MB_REG_50</code>	Structure	Per-channel configuration (declared by the application as <code>MB_CHANNELS</code>).

Global Constants and Variables

Access Modes

Constant	Value	Description
<code>MB_READ_WRITE</code>	<code>0</code>	Read and write.
<code>MB_READ</code>	<code>1</code>	Read only.
<code>MB_WRITE</code>	<code>2</code>	Write only.

Serial Port Settings

Constant	Value	Description
<code>MB_DL_7</code>	<code>0</code>	7 data bits.
<code>MB_DL_8</code>	<code>1</code>	8 data bits.
<code>MB_PARITY_NONE</code>	<code>0</code>	No parity.
<code>MB_PARITY_ODD</code>	<code>1</code>	Odd parity.
<code>MB_PARITY_EVEN</code>	<code>2</code>	Even parity.
<code>MB_STOPBIT_1</code>	<code>0</code>	1 stop bit.
<code>MB_STOPBIT_2</code>	<code>1</code>	2 stop bits.
<code>MB_BPS_600</code>	<code>0</code>	600 bps.
<code>MB_BPS_1200</code>	<code>1</code>	1200 bps.
<code>MB_BPS_2400</code>	<code>2</code>	2400 bps.

Constant	Value	Description
MB_BPS_4800	3	4800 bps.
MB_BPS_9600	4	9600 bps.
MB_BPS_19200	5	19200 bps.
MB_BPS_38400	6	38400 bps.
MB_BPS_57600	7	57600 bps.
MB_BPS_115200	8	115200 bps.

MB_DL_7 and MB_DL_8 are provided for completeness but are not selectable through MB_PORT_SETTINGS, which always configures **8 data bits**.

Ports

Constant	Value	Physical port
MB_PORT_2	0	RS485 port 2 — terminal connector (A, B)
MB_PORT_3	1	RS485 port 3 — DB9 connector (A1, B1)
MB_PORT_CAN	2	CAN port (H, L)
MB_PORT_TCP	3	Ethernet TCP port

Timeout Tuning

Variable	Type	Description
MB_TIMEOUT_COUNT	INT	Consecutive timeouts before a channel is suspended. Default: 2.
MB_SUSPEND_RETRY	INT	Suspended-channel retry interval, in 50 ms units. Default: 80 (4 s).
MB_TIMEOUT_TIME	INT	Timeout duration, in 50 ms units. Default: 4 (200 ms).

If any of these variables is left at 0, MB_PROCESS_50 applies the default value shown above at runtime.

MB_PORT_SETTINGS (Function)

Returns a correctly formatted bit-field value for initialising a port as either Master or Slave. The returned value is a **DWORD** bit-field for the port configuration register.

Variable	Scope	Type	Description
Parity	INPUT	INT	One of: MB_PARITY_NONE, MB_PARITY_ODD, MB_PARITY_EVEN.
StopBit	INPUT	INT	One of: MB_STOPBIT_1, MB_STOPBIT_2.
Baudrate	INPUT	INT	One of: MB_BPS_600, MB_BPS_1200, MB_BPS_2400, MB_BPS_4800, MB_BPS_9600, MB_BPS_19200, MB_BPS_38400, MB_BPS_57600,

Variable	Scope	Type	Description
			<code>MB_BPS_115200</code> .

Note: the data length is fixed at **8 data bits** and is not a parameter of this function.

Declare a local variable of type `DWORD` (e.g. `PortSettings`), then invoke the function:

```
VAR
    PortSettings : DWORD;
END_VAR

PortSettings := MB_PORT_SETTINGS(MB_PARITY_NONE, MB_STOPBIT_1, MB_BPS_9600);
```

Modbus Slave

`MB_SLAVE_INIT_PORT2`, `MB_SLAVE_INIT_PORT3`

These functions initialise the Modbus slave on port 2 or port 3 of the PLC, respectively.

Variable	Scope	Type	Description
<code>xInit</code>	INPUT	<code>BOOL</code>	Initialisation command. The slave is (re-)initialised on every rising edge.
<code>iAddress</code>	INPUT	<code>INT</code>	Modbus network address assigned to this PLC.
<code>PortSettings</code>	INPUT	<code>DWORD</code>	Return value of the <code>MB_PORT_SETTINGS</code> function.

Important — initialisation timing: the same caveat as for the master functions applies (see § Modbus Master). The function acts only on a rising edge of `xInit`, and triggering it solely from `M8002` may not reliably retain the port settings. Re-trigger it after startup, e.g. with the one-second clock `M8013`.

Example

The following snippet configures a slave with address `1` on port 2:

```
PortSettings := MB_PORT_SETTINGS(MB_PARITY_NONE, MB_STOPBIT_1, MB_BPS_9600);
M0 := MB_SLAVE_INIT_PORT2(M8013, 1, PortSettings);
```

No further configuration is necessary for the PLC to function as a slave on port 2. The same pattern applies to port 3. The variable `M0` is not referenced elsewhere in the program — it exists solely to satisfy the syntactic requirement that a function call used as a statement must have a left-hand side assignment.

Modbus Master

`MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT2`, `MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT3`

These functions initialise the Modbus Master on port 2 (terminal connector) or port 3 (DB9 connector), respectively.

Variable	Scope	Type	Description
<code>xInit</code>	INPUT	BOOL	Initialisation command. The master is (re-)initialised on every rising edge.
<code>PortSettings</code>	INPUT	DWORD	Return value of the <code>MB_PORT_SETTINGS</code> function.

Important — initialisation timing: The function acts only on a rising edge of `xInit`; re-initialising on every scan is **not required** and is **not performed**. Passing a constant `TRUE` fires the initialisation once, on the first scan. Triggering it solely from the `M8002` first-scan pulse is **not reliable**: the port configuration may not be retained because the settings can be overwritten later during startup. It is therefore recommended to re-trigger initialisation after startup. A common practice is to feed the one-second clock pulse `M8013` into `xInit`, so the port settings are re-written every second.

Example

```
PortSettings := MB_PORT_SETTINGS(MB_PARITY_NONE, MB_STOPBIT_1, MB_BPS_9600);
(* M8013 = 1 s clock: re-writes the port settings every second so they
   survive the startup overwrite. A constant TRUE fires only once. *)
M0 := MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT2(M8013, PortSettings);
```

Port Reconfiguration (Mitsubishi Protocol)

`MTB_SLAVE_PORT2`, `MTB_SLAVE_PORT3`

These functions reconfigure port 2 or port 3 to the Mitsubishi proprietary protocol (not Modbus RTU), set the station address to `1`, and set the serial format to **38400 baud, 7 data bits, even parity, 1 stop bit**. They are used to switch a port back from Modbus RTU to the Mitsubishi protocol.

Variable	Scope	Type	Description
<code>xInit</code>	INPUT	BOOL	Reconfiguration command. The port is reconfigured on every rising edge.

Example

```
M0 := MTB_SLAVE_PORT2(TRUE);
```

`MB_PROCESS_50` (Function Block)

This function block orchestrates all read and write operations across the configured channels. It must be called every scan (or at least faster than the shortest channel `tCycle`).

Prerequisite: The TimeControl library must be installed and `TCO_TICKER_50` must be running. This ticker advances at 50 ms intervals and drives the internal scheduling of channel operations.

Variable	Scope	Type	Description
<code>mb_xEnable</code>	INPUT	BOOL	Enables channel processing. When <code>FALSE</code> , the scheduler resets to its boot state.
<code>mb_iBuffer</code>	INPUT	INT	Base <code>D</code> device number of the scratch buffer used during <code>ADPRW</code> transfers. The scratch buffer holds up to <code>iNum</code> words for register channels, or $\lceil iNum / 16 \rceil$ words for coil channels (one bit per coil). It must not overlap any channel's value or change-tracking buffer.
<code>mb_Timeout</code>	OUTPUT	INT	Modbus slave device address (<code>iDev</code>) of the channel that timed out. <code>0</code> when no channel has timed out.

The `MB_REG_50` Structure

The application declares a global array `MB_CHANNELS` of type `MB_REG_50`, together with a global constant `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM` that holds the array's upper bound (last valid index). The library references both labels directly — it does not declare them. `MB_PROCESS_50` cycles through channels `0` to `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM`, so the number of channels is fully under application control (e.g. `c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM := 2` for 3 channels, `:= 29` for 30 channels). Each channel may read or write up to **125** registers. The array must be configured once, typically on PLC startup under the `M8002` initialisation pulse flag.

The structure contains user-configurable fields (set by the application) and library-managed fields (maintained internally; do not modify).

User-Configurable Fields

Variable	Type	Description
<code>xEnabled</code>	BOOL	Enable this channel for processing. When <code>FALSE</code> , the channel is skipped.
<code>iDevNum</code>	INT	Base device number of the value buffer. Register channels use <code>D</code> devices; coil channels use <code>M</code> devices. Each channel consumes $2 \times iNum$ devices. See § <code>iDevNum</code> for allocation rules.
<code>iNum</code>	INT	Number of registers or coils to read/write (max 125). Default (when <code>0</code>): <code>1</code> .
<code>iReg</code>	WORD	Starting Modbus register/coil address. Declared <code>WORD</code> (unsigned) so addresses above 32,000 can be specified.
<code>iRF</code>	WORD	Modbus read function code (<code>H1–H4</code>). Default (when <code>0</code>): <code>H3</code> .
<code>iWF</code>	WORD	Modbus write function code (<code>H5, H6, HF, H10</code>). Default (when <code>0</code>): <code>H6</code> .
<code>iDev</code>	WORD	Modbus slave device address.
<code>tCycle</code>	INT	Cycle interval for automatic reads/writes, in units of 50 ms. E.g. <code>20</code> = 1 second. Set to <code>0</code> for manual-only operation via <code>xReadOnce</code> / <code>xWriteOnce</code> .

Variable	Type	Description
iWR	INT	Read/write mode: MB_READ_WRITE, MB_READ, or MB_WRITE. Writes (including xWriteOnce / xWriteOnChange) require MB_READ_WRITE or MB_WRITE.
iPort	INT	Communication port identifier: MB_PORT_2, MB_PORT_3, MB_PORT_CAN, or MB_PORT_TCP. See § Ports.
xWriteOnChange	BOOL	When TRUE, changed values are written to the slave immediately upon detection. When FALSE, writes occur only when the tCycle interval elapses.
xReadOnce	BOOL	On a rising edge (FALSE → TRUE), triggers a single read of this channel. For manual-only reads, set tCycle to 0.
xWriteOnce	BOOL	On a rising edge (FALSE → TRUE), triggers a single write of this channel. For manual-only writes, set tCycle to 0.
xDone	BOOL	Read-only completion pulse. Set TRUE on completion of one read/write cycle; cleared at the start of the next cycle. Primarily useful for channels operating in manual mode (tCycle = 0).

Library-Managed Fields (Read-Only)

Variable	Type	Description
tStart	DWORD	Timestamp of the last completed operation (50 ms ticker).
iTimeOut	INT	Consecutive-timeout counter used for channel suspension.
isRegister	BOOL	TRUE = register channel, FALSE = coil channel. Derived from iRF/iWF.
xReadOnceM	BOOL	Rising-edge memory for xReadOnce.
xWriteOnceM	BOOL	Rising-edge memory for xWriteOnce.

Supported Read/Write Functions

Code	Mnemonic
H1	Read Coils
H2	Read Discrete Inputs
H3	Read Holding Registers
H4	Read Input Registers
H5	Write Single Coil
H6	Write Single Register
HF	Write Multiple Coils
H10	Write Multiple Registers

iDDevNum — Buffer Allocation

Each channel reserves **twice** the number of devices specified by `iNum`. Half of the allocation holds the actual register/coil values; the other half is used internally for change tracking. Register channels use the `D` device area; coil channels use the `M` device area.

If `iNum = 1` and `iDDevNum = 200`:

- `D200` stores the value.
- `D201` is reserved for internal use.

If `iNum = 5`:

- `D200–D204` store the values.
- `D205–D209` are reserved for internal use.

Caution: Failure to account for the internal buffer when assigning `iDDevNum` values across consecutive channels will result in data corruption.

Consider the following **incorrect** configuration:

```
MB_CHANNELS[0].iDDevNum := 600;  
MB_CHANNELS[0].iNum := 3;  
  
MB_CHANNELS[1].iDDevNum := 603;  
MB_CHANNELS[1].iNum := 1;
```

Channel 0 consumes devices `D600` through `D605` (3 values + 3 internal). The first free device is therefore `D606` — not `D603`. Assigning `iDDevNum := 603` to channel 1 causes its buffer to overlap with the internal area of channel 0, producing undefined behaviour.

The **correct** allocation is:

```
MB_CHANNELS[0].iDDevNum := 600;  
MB_CHANNELS[0].iNum := 3;  
  
MB_CHANNELS[1].iDDevNum := 606;  
MB_CHANNELS[1].iNum := 1;
```

`iWF` — Write Function Selection

Two write-function codes are available for register channels:

- **H6 (Write Single Register):** When assigned to a multi-register channel, only the register whose value changed is written in a dedicated request.
- **H10 (Write Multiple Registers):** When assigned to a multi-register channel, a change to any register within the group triggers a single request that updates the entire group.

Guidance:

- For double-word values spanning multiple registers → use `H10`.

- For multiple independent single-register variables on the same channel → use H6.
- For a single-register channel → use H6.

The same principle applies to coil channels: use H5 (Write Single Coil), even when the channel spans multiple coils.

Complete Example

Before configuring channels, declare the storage in the project's global label list. The following declares three channels (indices 0–2):

Label	Class	Type / Value
c_MB_CHANNELS_NUM	VAR_GLOBAL_CONSTANT	INT = 2
MB_CHANNELS	VAR_GLOBAL	ARRAY [0..2] OF MB_REG_50

Declare the function-block instance and the port bit-field in the local label section of the POU:

```
VAR
    fbMbProcess  : MB_PROCESS_50;
    PortSettings : DWORD;
END_VAR
```

M0, M1, M2, and M8002 in the example are device labels (auxiliary relays and the initialisation-pulse special relay) and do not require a VAR declaration.

```
IF M8002 THEN

    (* Number of consecutive timeouts before a channel is suspended. Default: 2 *)
    MB_TIMEOUT_COUNT := 2;
    (* Suspended-channel retry interval, in 50 ms units. Default: 80 (4 seconds)
    *)
    MB_SUSPEND_RETRY := 80;
    (* Timeout duration, in 50 ms units. Default: 4 (200 ms) *)
    MB_TIMEOUT_TIME := 4;

    PortSettings := MB_PORT_SETTINGS(MB_PARITY_NONE, MB_STOPBIT_1, MB_BPS_9600);

    (* Automatic read/write channel on port 2 *)
    MB_CHANNELS[0].xEnabled := TRUE;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iDDevNum := 600;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iNum := 3;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iReg := K16384;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iRF := H3;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iWF := H6;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iDev := H1;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].tCycle := 20; (* 20 x 50 ms = 1 000 ms = 1 second *)
    MB_CHANNELS[0].xWriteOnChange := TRUE;
    MB_CHANNELS[0].iWR := MB_READ_WRITE;
```

```

MB_CHANNELS[0].iPort := MB_PORT_2;

(* Minimal setup – connects to a device via Port 3 *)
MB_CHANNELS[1].xEnabled := TRUE;
MB_CHANNELS[1].iDDevNum := 610;
MB_CHANNELS[1].iReg := K16385;
MB_CHANNELS[1].iDev := K16;
MB_CHANNELS[1].tCycle := 4;
MB_CHANNELS[1].iWR := MB_READ;
MB_CHANNELS[1].iPort := MB_PORT_3;

(* Manual-cycle read/write of a 3-register group *)
MB_CHANNELS[2].xEnabled := TRUE;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iNum := 3;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iDev := H1;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iPort := MB_PORT_3;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iDDevNum := 10;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iReg := H1000;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iRF := H3;
MB_CHANNELS[2].iWR := MB_READ_WRITE;
MB_CHANNELS[2].tCycle := 0;
END_IF;

(* Multi-master mode is available on both ports for L02-series PLCs.
   M8013 = 1 s clock re-writes the port settings every second so they
   survive the startup overwrite. *)
M0 := MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT2(M8013, PortSettings);
M0 := MB_MASTER_INIT_PORT3(M8013, PortSettings);

fbMbProcess(mb_xEnable := TRUE, mb_iBuffer := 100);

(* Manually read channel 2 once *)
IF M1 THEN
  MB_CHANNELS[2].xReadOnce := TRUE;
  IF MB_CHANNELS[2].xDone = TRUE THEN
    M1 := FALSE;
    MB_CHANNELS[2].xReadOnce := FALSE;
  END_IF;
END_IF;

(* Manually write channel 2 once *)
IF M2 THEN
  D10 := 100;
  D11 := 100;
  D12 := 100;
  MB_CHANNELS[2].xWriteOnce := TRUE;
  IF MB_CHANNELS[2].xDone = TRUE THEN
    M2 := FALSE;
    MB_CHANNELS[2].xWriteOnce := FALSE;
  END_IF;
END_IF;

```

Post-configuration behaviour:

- **D600**, **D601**, and **D602** hold the three register values read from device address **1**, refreshed every second. If any value changes locally, the slave is updated immediately (**xWriteOnChange := TRUE**).
- **D610** holds the single register value read from device address **16**. Since this channel is configured as read-only (**MB_READ**), any local modification to **D610** is overwritten by the next read cycle (every 200 ms).
- Channel 2 (**tCycle = 0**) performs no automatic transfers. It is read or written only when **xReadOnce** / **xWriteOnce** is pulsed.

Alternative Write Confirmation

The expression **IF D10 = D13 AND D11 = D14 AND D12 = D15 THEN** implements a buffer-comparison strategy for verifying write completion.

As described in § **iDDevNum**, each channel reserves twice the number of devices specified by **iNum**. With **iDDevNum := 10** and **iNum := 3**:

- **D10–D12** hold the actual register values.
- **D13–D15** serve as the change-tracking buffer.

Upon a successful write, the library updates the change-tracking buffer to match the newly written values. Therefore, equality between the value registers and their corresponding change-tracking registers confirms that the write has completed.

```
(* Alternative write-confirmation technique *)
IF M2 THEN
  D10 := 200;
  D11 := 200;
  D12 := 200;
  MB_CHANNELS[2].xWriteOnce := TRUE;
  IF D10 = D13 AND D11 = D14 AND D12 = D15 THEN
    M2 := FALSE;
    MB_CHANNELS[2].xWriteOnce := FALSE;
  END_IF;
END_IF;
```

This technique is particularly useful when employing **xWriteOnChange** (rather than **xWriteOnce**) with a multi-register channel and write function **H6**. If, for example, two registers within a ten-register channel are modified, **H6** writes each one individually, setting **xDone** once per successful write. Counting two distinct **xDone** pulses can rapidly become unwieldy. In contrast, a single comparison of the form **IF D10 = D13 AND D11 = D14 AND ...** confirms that all changed registers have been successfully propagated to the slave in a single check.

Timeout and Suspension Mechanism

The library implements a channel-suspension policy for fault tolerance. If a channel fails to receive a response for **MB_TIMEOUT_COUNT** consecutive attempts, it is flagged as **suspended**. Once suspended, the channel is polled at a reduced rate — once every **MB_SUSPEND_RETRY** interval. As soon as a valid response is received, the suspension flag is cleared and the channel resumes its normal cycle interval as defined by **MB_CHANNELS[*].tCycle**.